

14 Tips to Have a Frugal Vacation and Still Treat Yourself

How do you vacation frugally, yet not allow your budget to compromise your traveling experience?

On one hand, you're on vacation, so you don't exactly want to squeeze every penny until it screams. The very idea of going on vacation means treating yourself to a special experience, seeing new things, and meeting new people. If you refuse yourself that museum admission, or that meal at a restaurant you've been dying to try, or the tour you've dreamed of taking, then what is the point of even leaving home in the first place?

Then again, if you go to town and spare no expense while on vacation, you may compromise your finances, and come home to a mess that may not only take a long time to clean up, but may also cause you to think twice about going away again.

Here are a few tips to help you balance out that vacation to enjoy the

things you want to do, while keeping your checkbook balanced.

EATING

Meals will make up one of the most expensive parts of your trip. If you are unable to cook for yourself in a hostel, you are relegated to eating largely at restaurants, which will in turn eat up your cash pretty quickly.

1. Go to that special restaurant, but for lunch, not dinner

Oftentimes, the menu items and portions are similar, but the price can be as little as half of what you would pay for dinner.

2. Scrimp on breakfast

At home, you probably have a fairly plain breakfast: toast, or cereal. But when you go to a restaurant for breakfast, you'll likely end up ordering the full meal deal, and not only roll away having eaten more than you are used to, but also having spent way more money than you needed to. Instead, pick up some groceries at the local store (ideally a grocery store, not a convenience store!). Most hotel rooms have a minibar fridge where you can store anything that requires